through establishment of nurseries and tissue culture units, production and productivity improvement programmes through area expansion and rejuvenation, technology promotion, technology dissemination, human resource development, creation of infrastructure for post-harvest management and marketing in consonance with the comparative advantages of each state/region and their diverse agro-climatic conditions are the major programmes of the Mission. A major initiative has been taken during 2011-12 for enhancing the supply of good quality vegetables to metro cities under the *Vegetable Initiative in Urban Clusters (VIUC).*

NATIONAL BAMBOO MISSION(NBM)

The NBM, a centrally sponsored scheme of the Ministry of Agriculture for harnessing the potential of the bamboo crop in the country, is under implementation in 27 states. It envisages promoting *holistic growth of the bamboo sector* by adopting an area-based, regionally differentiated strategy to increase the area under bamboo cultivation and marketing[44]. Under the Mission, steps have been taken to increase the availability of quality planting material by supporting the setting up of new nurseries/tissue culture units and strengthening existing ones. To address forward integration, the Mission is taking steps to strengthen marketing of bamboo products, especially those of handicraft items. Besides the Mission has provided financial assistance to different institutions/universities for twenty-three R&D projects aimed at higher productivity of bamboo. Agro-forestry trials comprising bamboo grown along with agricultural/horticultural crops and medicinal plants under different agro-climatic conditions in various states have been initiated.

NATIONAL AGRICULTURAL POLICY, 2000[45]

Union Government has announced new National Agricultural Policy in the parliament on July 28, 2000. This policy has been planned under the